20-Mark Evaluation Chain – Exam-Ready Structure (Unit 1)

Purpose: Use this structure to move from an 8–10 mark answer into the top end of the band.
Key rule: Judgement must appear THROUGHOUT the answer, not just in the conclusion.

Step 1: Set the context (brief)

- Name the business
- State the objective (e.g. increase market share)
- Identify key market conditions (competition, economy)

Step 2: Strategy A – Benefit + Judgement

- What is Strategy A?
- How does it work?
- Why does it help achieve the objective?
- Is it more effective in the short term or long term?

Sentence starter:
"This leads to…, which is particularly effective in the short/long term because…"

Step 2b: Strategy A – HOWEVER + Comparison

- What limits the effectiveness of Strategy A?
- Why is this limitation more serious compared to Strategy B?

Sentence starter:
"However, this is less sustainable than Strategy B because…"

Step 3: Strategy B – Benefit + Judgement

- What is Strategy B?
- How does it help achieve the objective?
- Is it more effective in the short term or long term?

Sentence starter:
"This creates longer-term benefits as…"

Step 3b: Strategy B – HOWEVER + Comparison

- What limits Strategy B?
- Why is this limitation less important than Strategy A's?

Sentence starter:
"However, despite higher initial costs, this is more sustainable than Strategy A because…"

Step 4: Embedded Prioritisation (Before Conclusion)

- Which strategy is more important overall?
- Why does it matter more for this business and objective?

Sentence starter:
"Overall, Strategy B has a greater impact on long-term success than Strategy A because…"

Step 5: Final Judgement (NOT a summary)

- Clearly prioritise one strategy
- Link directly back to the objective
- Explain when your judgement could change

Sentence starters:
"Therefore, the business should prioritise…"
"However, this judgement would change if…"

Top-Band 20-Mark Checklist

☐ Judgement appears in each strategy paragraph
☐ Strategies are compared throughout
☐ Short-term vs long-term impact considered
☐ One strategy clearly prioritised
☐ Conclusion ranks strategies and is conditional